

1924



Seaside "White flannels", trousers made of light, brushed woollen cloth, were recommended for summer, whether staying at the Riviera or an English seaside town. Flannels were worn with belts, rather than braces.

1925



Double-breasted By mid-decade the suit was less fitted and worn with slightly wider trousers. Sir Arthur Conan Doyle wears his double-breasted suit with a soft collar shirt and club tie. The light colour of the homburg hat is echoed in the spats.

HATS AND SHOES

Men in the 1920s could choose from a variety of hat shapes that had all been introduced in the previous century. Apart from the top hat, lounge suits could be worn with every hat type. The bowler, also called derby or coke, was the most formal, followed by the homburg, a stiff felt with a centre crease and rolled brim. The trilby and wider-brimmed fedora, both named after literary characters, were everyday city hats, while the boater or other varieties of straw hat were for summer or the beach.



Bowler hat



Felt trilby



Straw boater hat

Shoes had gradually replaced boots since the turn of the century. These were mainly of the lace-up Oxford type and had to be matched to the rest of the outfit and the season. Dark business suits were worn with black or tan shoes, but in summer shoes of white leather or cotton duck accessorized white flannels or Palm Beach suits. Towards the end of the decade two-tone shoes became all the rage.



Box calf sandal

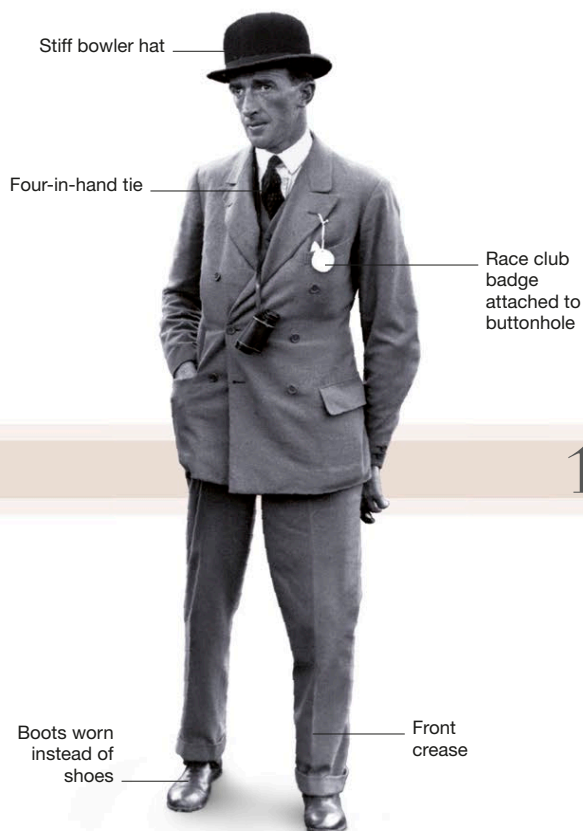


Two-tone Oxford

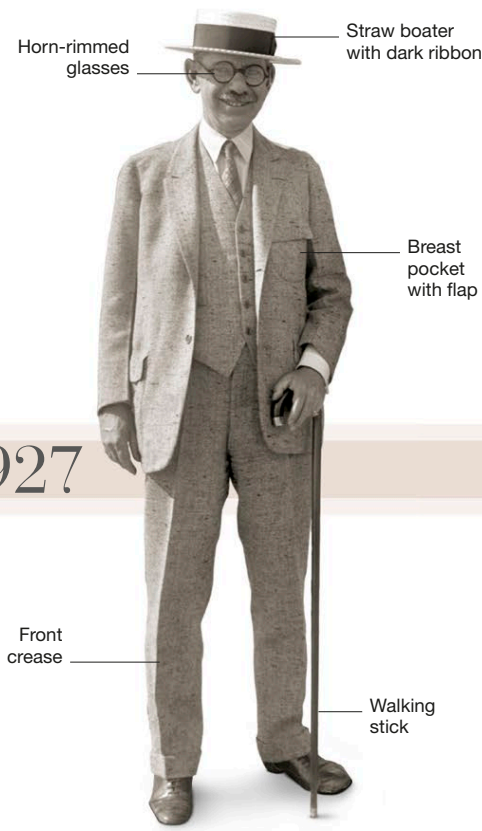


Tan Oxford

1927



The races The meaning of a lounge suit could be transformed by the choice of hat and shirt. This Yorkshire racegoer teams a light, double-breasted suit with a starched collar and a relatively formal bowler hat.



Florida beachwear Marcus Lowe, vice president of Metro-Goldwyn Pictures, wears a lightweight "Palm Beach" suit for a day on the beach. He sports a boater, which remained fashionable for summer wear throughout the decade.